

E-commerce Order Management System — Workflow & Recommendations

1. Customer Ordering Flow

1. **Landing page** — Two buttons: *Place Order* and *Track Order*.
2. **Enter name & contact** — Modal form collects customer name and contact number. Click *Next* to proceed.
3. **Browse products** — Product cards displayed; user adds items to cart.
4. **Order summary** — Cart icon opens a modal showing items, quantity, cost per item, and total cost. *Proceed to Checkout* button below.
5. **Checkout page** — Shows order summary, customer name & contact, and a **Pickup Date** field (date + time selection).
6. **Pay here** — Modal with a QR code and required fields: Reference Number, date/time of payment, amount paid. Clicking *Done* unlocks the *Place Order* button.
7. **Place order → Track order** — Redirects to a Track Order page showing the generated Order Number and live status.

2. Staff Order Pipeline (Kanban)

Left panel navigation: **New Order → Review Payment → Order Preparation → Ready for Pick-up → Completed**, plus a **Cancelled** column.

Stage	Card shows	Action button	Moves to
New Order	Order number (title)	Accept Order (modal: name, contact, order summary, total, transaction #, payment date/time, amount)	Review Payment
Review Payment	Order number, transaction #, payment date/time, amount	Confirm Payment	Order Preparation
Order Preparation	Order number, item summary	Complete	Ready for Pick-up
Ready for Pick-up	Order number	Pickup Complete	Completed
Completed	Table: order #, date/time placed, amount paid, date/time picked up	—	—
Cancelled	Can be triggered from any stage (needs definition — see recommendations)	—	—

3. Admin Panel Structure

- **Dashboard** — Cards for total orders, pending, ready for pickup, completed, cancelled. Filterable by daily / weekly / monthly / yearly / custom date range.
- **Sales analytics** — Product-level sales analytics.
- **Sales history & logs** — Table of orders (order #, date/time placed, amount, status) with *View Detail* modal showing order summary, user details, payment history, and a staff action timeline (acceptance → completion).
- **Edit Menu Catalog** — Existing products shown as cards; *+Add Product* modal collects Product Name, Description, Cost, Max Quantity per Order, Max Order Quantity per Day, and Add Image.
- **Update Payment Method** — View and update/add payment modes.
- **Manage Staff Access** — Staff account/permission management.

4. Recommendations

1. **Payment verification is currently self-reported.** The customer submits their own

reference number, amount, and timestamp, and staff manually cross-checks it — this is the biggest fraud risk in the system (fake or reused reference numbers).

- Integrate an actual payment gateway (GCash/Maya API, PayMongo) to verify transactions programmatically.
- If manual verification stays for now, require a screenshot upload of the payment confirmation alongside the reference number.

2. **Order number collisions / duplicate submissions.** Double-clicking or refreshing during submission could create duplicate orders.

- Disable the *Place Order* button on click.
- Generate the order ID server-side before confirming.

3. **No defined behavior for "Max Order Quantity per Day" being reached.** It's unclear what the user sees when a product hits its daily cap mid-session.

- Grey out / disable the product card once the daily limit is hit, rather than rejecting it at checkout.

4. **Cancellation flow is undefined.** Who can cancel (staff only, or the user pre-payment) and from which stages isn't specified — this also affects refund handling.

- Define explicit cancellation rules and which roles can trigger them.

5. **Pickup date/time validation.** Since the customer freely selects this, add:

- Business-hours constraints.
- A minimum lead time so orders aren't scheduled before staff can realistically prepare them.

6. **No notifications in the flow.** Customers currently must revisit the Track Order page to check status.

- Add SMS or push notifications on status change (e.g., "Ready for pickup") to reduce repeat visits and no-shows.